

CASE ID: 200203710732

EPISODE NAME: China-South Korea Steel Imports

2002/03/26 - 2008/09/23

Sender: China (710)

Target: South Korea (732)

Issue: Trade Practices (13)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Narrative:

On 2004/01/14, China imposed anti-dumping tariffs of up to 55 percent on cold rolled steel products from Taiwan, South Korea, Russia, Ukraine and Kazakhstan.¹

The initial onset of the episode began on 2002/03/26, when China's Ministry of Foreign Trade and Economic Cooperation announced the beginning of an anti-dumping investigation into the five countries' cold-rolled steel, following allegations from Chinese steel conglomerates.²

The investigation found all countries involved guilty of dumping cold-rolled steel into the Chinese market, with China's Ministry of Commerce explaining that, "the ministry has decided that dumping of such products does exist, and has caused substantial damage."³

Chinese steel company Wuhan Steel welcomed the decision, saying that, "the decision will have a positive impact on the company's operations and production."⁴ Other Chinese steel companies, such as Shanghai Baosteel Group Corporation and Anshan Iron & Steel Group, alongside the aforementioned Wuhan Steel, had lobbied China to open a probe into steel imports.⁵

The sanctions expired on 2008/09/23.⁶ None of the countries are reported to have retaliated.

¹ "China slaps duties on steel," *CNN*, January 14th, 2004,.

<https://www.cnn.com/2004/BUSINESS/01/14/china.steel.reut/>.

² Richard Dobson, "China Looks into Reports of Dumping," *Taipei Times*, March 27th, 2002, <https://www.taipeitimes.com/News/biz/archives/2002/03/27/0000129449>.

³ "China slaps duties on steel," *CNN*, January 14th, 2004, <https://www.cnn.com/2004/BUSINESS/01/14/china.steel.reut/>.

⁴ Ibid.

⁵ Richard Dobson, "China Looks into Reports of Dumping," *Taipei Times*, March 27th, 2002, <https://www.taipeitimes.com/News/biz/archives/2002/03/27/0000129449>.

⁶ "China slaps duties on steel," *CNN*, January 14th, 2004, <https://www.cnn.com/2004/BUSINESS/01/14/china.steel.reut/>.